

Optum Insight BI Visualization Tool — Proposal

Sep 22, 2026

This proposal lays out the market research, target users, required data sources and KPI set for a BI visualization tool that shows Optum Insight where they're winning, losing, and have savings opportunities — the opening engagement toward an ongoing project relationship with Optum as a long-term client.

1. Market research on Optum

Optum Insight is UnitedHealth Group's data-and-analytics arm. It is mid-turnaround: 2025 was rough, but 2026 results show the new AI-first strategy already paying off.

Company & scale (FY2025)

Segment	Revenue	YoY	Adjusted operating margin
UnitedHealth Group (total)	\$447.6B	+12%	4.8%
Optum (total)	\$270.6B	+7%	4.2%
Optum Health	\$102.0B	-3%	2.2%
Optum Insight	\$19.4B	+4%	19.2%
Optum Rx	\$154.7B	+16%	4.0%

Strategy shift: old model vs. AI-first bet

	2024 (services + M&A model)	2025 (transition year)	2026 (AI-first, in progress)
Optum Insight revenue	\$18.8B	\$19.4B (+4%)	>\$21.0B guided; \$5.4B in Q2 alone
GAAP operating earnings	\$3.1B	\$2.6B (down, despite revenue growth)	Guided >\$4.75B on a recast basis
Adjusted operating margin	23.4% (highest of any Optum segment)	19.2% reported (21.7% recast)	~22.6% guided; 25.3% actual in Q2
What drove it	Scale via the 2022 Change Healthcare acquisition (\$13B) and	Cyberattack recovery costs plus new AI product launch costs	~\$1.5B UnitedHealth-wide AI investment in 2026; autonomous coding, digital prior

	2024 (services + M&A model)	2025 (transition year)	2026 (AI-first, in progress)
	services cross-sell	compressed margin	auth (96% first-pass approval), Value Connect (17% pharmacy cost cuts for early customers)
Key risk	Concentration in one platform (Change Healthcare) — realized as the Feb 2024 breach, ~190M Americans affected	3 different CEOs in 2025 (de Crescenzo → Suryadevara → Dadlani)	Execution risk of scaling AI products into recurring revenue; trust still rebuilding

The 2026 recast folds Optum Financial Services into Optum Insight, so the reported-vs-recast margin gap isn't pure like-for-like — but even on a recast basis, margin is recovering, not just revenue.

Competitive landscape

Competitor	AI / product move	Scale
Elevance Health (Carelton)	Health OS platform cut prior-auth denials ~70%; AI assistant live for 22M+ commercial members, expanding to Medicare in 2026	\$1B AI/digital spend
Cigna (Evernorth)	"Pharmacy Forward" AI cuts clinician documentation time up to 50%, halves prescription turnaround	\$100M through 2028; ~\$400M expected value by 2028
CVS Health (Aetna/Caremark)	Bundled medical + pharmacy prior auth; generative AI across the Aetna Health app	Part of CVS Health's \$20B multi-year digital investment
Humana	AI in care management, prior auth, member engagement; predictive analytics for high-risk members	Not disclosed
Epic / Oracle Health	Embedding AI (ambient scribes, note drafting, predictive analytics) directly into the EHR at the point of care	Structural threat to Optum Insight's data-connector role

Optum Insight is proving its AI bet out financially, but rivals are shipping comparable proof points on similar timelines — a fast, credible "where we're winning, losing and can save" view is a well-timed pitch for a CEO managing that race.

2. Target users & discovery questions

Each user group needs a different slice of the same underlying data.

User group	Why they'd use it
Optum Insight CEO / C-suite	Cross-segment "where we're winning/losing" narrative for the board
OptumHealth / OptumRx segment leads	Margin and cost drivers specific to their P&L
Regional/market presidents	Local membership, revenue, medical care ratio
Finance / FP&A / actuarial	MCR trend, PMPM cost, pricing adequacy
Sales & growth / broker relations	RFP win/loss, membership growth vs. attrition
Provider network & contracting	Network adequacy, unit cost, provider performance
Clinical / medical management	Care gaps, quality/Star ratings, cost trend drivers
Payment integrity / revenue cycle ops	\$ savings identified, claims accuracy & turnaround
Optum Insight's own data/IT team	Data governance, source systems, integration feasibility
Board / investor relations	External-facing performance story

Discovery questions to ask them

1. What decision will this dashboard actually change, and how is that decision made today without it?
2. How do you define "winning" vs. "losing" in your area — revenue growth, margin, membership retention, MCR, quality scores?
3. Which markets or product lines are outliers right now, and how long does it take you to find that out today?
4. What data do you already distrust, and why?
5. Do you need self-service drill-down, or a fixed monthly/quarterly scorecard?
6. What would a concrete "savings opportunity" look like — payment integrity recoveries, re-contracting, care management ROI, admin efficiency?
7. What refresh cadence do you need — near-real-time, weekly, monthly?
8. What constraints exist on PHI handling, data residency, or role-based access?

3. Required data sources

Source	What it feeds
Claims data (medical + pharmacy)	Cost/utilization drivers of MCR — from the claims clearinghouse (Change Healthcare) and OptumRx pharmacy claims
Membership/enrollment data	Growth and attrition by line of business (Commercial, MA, Medicaid, Other) and by state
Financial/GL & actuarial data	Segment P&L, revenue, cost of care, admin cost, rate filings
Provider network data	Network adequacy, contracted rates, provider-level performance
Quality/clinical data	HEDIS measures, CMS Star ratings, care-gap closure, EHR-sourced data
Payment integrity / revenue cycle systems	Fraud/waste/abuse recoveries, denial rates, claims turnaround — Optum Insight's own product telemetry
CRM/sales pipeline	RFP win/loss, broker performance, renewal rates
Customer experience data	NPS/CSAT, complaints, appeals
External benchmarks	CMS public MA enrollment/penetration files, competitor market share, state Medicaid rate data
Operational resiliency data	System uptime, cyber-incident tracking — directly relevant given the Change Healthcare history

4. KPIs by role, with objective

Each role gets its own KPI set, not one shared list, because each is trying to answer a different question from the same underlying data.

Optum Insight CEO / C-suite

KPI	Objective
Revenue growth YoY, by segment	See whether the AI-first strategy is translating into top-line growth
Adjusted operating margin, by segment	Confirm new-product investment is being recovered in profitability

KPI	Objective
Top-10 / bottom-10 state ranking	Give one view of where the business is over- or under-performing plan
AI pilot-to-contract conversion rate	Measure whether AI investment is turning into recurring revenue

OptumHealth / OptumRx segment leads

KPI	Objective
Segment revenue vs. plan	Track delivery against the segment's own growth target
Medical care ratio / cost PMPM	Monitor whether medical cost trend is staying within budget
Adjusted scripts / patients served growth	Track the volume driving segment revenue
Segment operating margin trend	See whether segment profitability is improving or compressing

Regional / market presidents

KPI	Objective
State-level membership growth/attrition	Flag which markets are gaining or losing members
State-level revenue and MCR	Identify which states are profitable vs. loss-making
Top-10 / bottom-10 state ranking	Prioritize where to intervene first
Local network adequacy	Confirm provider access isn't limiting growth

Finance / FP&A / actuarial

KPI	Objective
Medical care ratio (reported and adjusted)	Track underwriting and pricing accuracy
Pricing adequacy vs. medical cost trend	Catch rate-setting gaps before they hit margin
Cash flow from operations	Monitor funding available for reinvestment, including AI spend
Days claims payable / days sales outstanding	Track working-capital health

Sales & growth / broker relations

KPI	Objective
RFP win rate	Measure competitiveness against Elevance, Cigna and CVS in new business
Membership growth vs. attrition, by channel	See where new sales are being offset by losses
Renewal rate	Track retention of the existing book of business
Broker/channel performance	Identify which channels drive profitable growth

Provider network & contracting

KPI	Objective
Network adequacy score	Ensure the network meets access requirements
Contracted unit cost trend	Monitor whether contracting is controlling cost growth
Provider performance/quality score	Identify high- and low-performing providers for steerage
In-network utilization rate	Track whether members are staying in-network for cost control

Clinical / medical management

KPI	Objective
HEDIS / Star ratings	Track quality performance tied to CMS bonus payments
Care-gap closure rate	Measure how well care management programs close gaps
Readmission rate	Monitor avoidable utilization and care coordination
Value-based care patient growth	Track the shift toward risk-based, lower-cost care models

Payment integrity / revenue cycle ops

KPI	Objective
\$ savings identified/recovered	Quantify the ROI Optum Insight delivers to payer/provider clients

KPI	Objective
Claims accuracy rate	Track the quality of automated claims adjudication
Claims turnaround time	Measure administrative efficiency gains from AI tools
Denial rate / first-pass approval rate	Track digital prior-auth performance against the 96% benchmark

Optum Insight's own data/IT team

KPI	Objective
Data quality/accuracy score	Ensure the dashboard's numbers are trustworthy
System uptime	Track platform resiliency, critical after the Change Healthcare breach
Data integration coverage (% of source systems connected)	Monitor how complete the underlying data picture is
Dashboard adoption rate	Track whether target roles are actually using the tool

Board / investor relations

KPI	Objective
Adjusted EPS / net margin	The headline number investors track each quarter
Revenue and earnings vs. guidance	Track whether the company is delivering on public commitments
Cyberattack-related cost run-off	Show investors the Change Healthcare cost tail is shrinking
AI investment ROI narrative	Give the board data to defend the \$1.5B AI spend